IGP Case Quick Reference

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One-glance facts for the open-book exam. Cases in session order. Each has: setting, key people, the facts and numbers, and the core issue / course themes.

1. Ramesh and Gargi (A) (Session 2)

Setting: Chrysalis Pharmaceuticals (MNC), India HQ Chennai, set up 2009. Grew in 4 years to 4 plants, 1,200 employees. Case written by Prof. Neharika Vohra (IIMA).

People

- **Ramesh Sharma**: Head of L&D. XLRI PMIR alumnus, 15+ yrs at a large oil company (25,000 staff), rose to deputy HR head. Chrysalis's 5th employee, handpicked by the CEO and VP-HR. Values consensus, team discussion, keeping everyone in the loop.
- **Gargi Sinha**: young TISS MBA, 3 yrs in L&D at Microsoft. Kamla spotted her at a "women in industry" seminar. Ebullient, informal, confident, networks easily. Role split: **60% CSR** (reports to Kamla + Vikram) / **40% L&D** (reports to Ramesh).
- **Kamla Saxena**: VP-HR, 3rd employee; reserved, conservative. Hired Gargi without telling Ramesh, now openly favours her.
- **Raman Murthy**: CEO. **Vikram Agarwal**: head of finance, hard to please, praised Gargi's CSR budget.
- **Ramesh's team:** Fiona (senior coordinator, 20 yrs), Debjeet and Saurabh (technical training), Naresh (medical rep training, works with marketing head Abhinav Sood).

Key events

- First met Gargi in the elevator 7 months earlier. He had not asked for a new hire, and diversity & inclusion (D&I) was news to him. He felt "blindsided".
- Gargi ran a virtual women's forum (with Kamla's OK, IT and Fiona) and a D&I panel without consulting him. Ramesh learned of the panel from an ex-colleague at Westside. Gargi only cc'd him on general emails, which he didn't open.
- Kamla, when he tried to raise it: "sort it out with Gargi, give her space, teach her the culture."
- Gargi: erratic hours (online at 4 am), travelled without telling him, refused to help with his strategic-planning event ("not my role").
- Team effects: Fiona sides with Gargi and shuts down complaints; Debjeet asks to come late or leave early; Naresh starts an initiative without telling Ramesh.
- Kamla didn't call him once during his 3-week vacation (his wife notes he took it in a lean period).

- Gargi coordinated the "Great Places to Work" survey: special mention for D&I and "Most Promising New Entrant". She was invited to the division-heads' dinner, praised by Raman, and Ramesh overheard Raman and Kamla discussing an expanded L&D role for her. He left early and replied to headhunters.

Core issue / themes: perceived loss of power and status, threat from a high performer, ambiguous reporting (dual reporting), boss favouritism, unclear role boundaries, a difficult conversation Ramesh keeps avoiding, indirect communication, generational and style differences, his own sense-making biases.

2. "Go Around": AXB 1344's Final Landing 2020 (A) (Session 4.1)

Setting: Air India Express (AIXL) Boeing 737-800, Dubai to Kozhikode (Calicut), **7 Aug 2020, 19:41 IST**, Vande Bharat repatriation flight during COVID. Tabletop runway, monsoon, night.

Outcome: Touched down well beyond the touchdown zone, overran Runway 10 at about 85 kt, fell into a **30-ft gorge**, broke into 3 pieces. **Both pilots died; 19 of 184 passengers died (21 of 190 on board); 75 seriously injured.**

Crew

- **PIC (captain):** 59, ex-military, ATPL, **10,848 hrs**, Line Training Captain (LTC) since Nov 2017, **36 Kozhikode flights** in the prior year (mostly headwind, so complacency). Failed the B777 command upgrade in 2013 and moved to AIXL. **At least 8 adverse training remarks (2009–14):** loses concentration under stress, floats, long landings, once needed physical assistance. Diabetic (2016). Was taking **un-prescribed antidiabetics (Glimepiride + Ayurvedic)**, with hypoglycaemia as a probable cognitive factor.
- **FO (co-pilot):** 32, CPL, about 2,000 hrs. SOPs empowered and required him to take control. He did not.

Sequence

- Briefing: PIC aware of the weather; Cochin alternate about 30 min away with adequate fuel.
- First approach on Rwy 28 (ILS): captain's **wiper failed**, so they went around.
- ATC switched to Rwy 10 and the PIC accepted. Headwind became **tailwind** on a wet runway. **No re-briefing, no landing-distance calculation, no diversion discussion.**
- Unstabilised approach: crossed the threshold at **169 kt ground speed**, **floated about 10 s**.

- FO calls escalate weakly: "Rate of descent" → PIC "Check" → "Rate of descent… Captain" → PIC "Yeah, correcting…" (irritated) → FO "(Up/Um)… OK?" (feeble) → "Just check it" → "Captain?" → **"Go around" at about 10 ft**. PIC ignored it. After touchdown the reversers were deployed, stowed, then redeployed (indecision).

Organisational and systemic factors

- **Steep cockpit authority gradient**, a "culture of silence"; CRM training was a ritual ("not proving meaningful").
- **Operations over safety:** only **1 captain vs 26 FOs** at Kozhikode; the PIC was rostered for a Doha flight next morning (rescheduled 08:30 → 10:00), so a diversion would have left no captain. He was anxious to arrive on time ("get-home-itis").
- Leadership scattered (corporate office Kochi, maintenance Thiruvananthapuram, ops/training/safety in Mumbai, chiefs based in Chennai/Delhi). COO dual role with Air India. Flight-safety chief had dual reporting.
- SMS a compliance exercise: training cut from 5 to 3 days and the manual later amended to match. FOQA covered only 89–94% of flights; long landings were not monitored. Simulator faulty with no contaminated-runway option ("negative training"). No aviation-medicine specialist since Feb 2015.
- Airport: wind sensor at 3.5 m (vs 10 m), so under-reported wind; no centreline lights; RESA 240 m and poorly maintained.
- Regulator (DGCA): accepted low FOQA figures, didn't check critical airfields, closed audits without follow-up.
- **Mangalore 2010 echo** (same airline, aircraft and tabletop runway; 158 of 166 died; FO called go-around 3 times and was ignored). Its recommendations were "implemented on paper" only. Also Mangalore 2019 (VT-AYA): go-around call ignored.

AAIB probable cause: PF didn't follow SOPs (continued an unstabilised approach and landed halfway down the runway despite the go-around call) **and** PM failed to take over.

Themes: authority gradient, voice vs silence, psychological safety, power distance, obedience to authority, CRM, individual vs organisational accountability, normalisation of deviance, learning organisations.

3. Strike in Space (Session 6.1)

Setting: NASA Skylab (1973–74). Budget **$2.5 bn**, under Congressional pressure; the future Space Shuttle depended on its success. 3 crews: 28 / 56 (54 actual) / **84 days**. Original goal: can humans live in weightlessness without harm? Mission control in Houston.

Key people: Neil Hutchinson, lead flight director: control-oriented, schedules every minute ("6 feet of instructions a day", "we controlled their destiny"). **William Schneider**, Skylab program director: told crew 3 to take it easy, then gave them crew 2's peak workloads.

Crews

- **Crew 1 (Conrad, Kerwin, Weitz):** rescued the damaged station (parasol, solar panel), heroes; gave up rest days; asked for a private conference that bypassed mission control (policy violation, reprimanded).
- **Crew 2 (Bean, Garriott, Lousma):** favourites of mission control. Close ties to crew 1 (Conrad–Bean were Navy and Apollo 12 buddies). Asked for heavy schedules, worked extra, skipped meals and averaged 6 hrs sleep. Garriott (science pilot, "science nut") gave the work meaning; Bean said the mission would have been 50% less productive without him. Their output became Hutchinson's **new baseline**.
- **Crew 3 (Carr, cdr; Pogue, pilot; Gibson, science pilot): all rookies**, no ties to the earlier crews. Carr missed Apollo 20. Pogue struggled with weightlessness (vomited). Gibson was independent and a dissenter ("contrariest"), and wanted a "shopping list" not a minute-by-minute schedule.

Escalation

- They hid Pogue's vomiting, but the open "B" channel taped it. **First public reprimand in flight** (Alan Shepard). Defensive from day 1.
- Ignored lessons: Bean advised 50% more time early on; a reduced workload for the first 10–12 days had been promised. Instead they got more, new, unfamiliar experiments added late (no sense of meaning). Only 10 min between experiments. Work scheduled into meals, evenings (8–10 pm free time) and exercise.
- Stowage chaos: about 40,000 items in 100+ cabinets left messy by earlier crews. Errors followed: iodine valve, near-flood, **80% of earth-resource photos lost** (wrong filters).
- Flight surgeons tried to help but had no channel ("the flight schedule is a nonmedical duty").
- **27 Dec 1973 (end of week 6):** the crew stopped work for a day, turned off the radio, and Carr made a "declaration of independence". Mission later extended (10 Jan) to 84 days, with splashdown 8 Feb 1974.

Themes: autonomy vs control, job design (meaningfulness, autonomy), goal conflict and drift, mixed messages from management, anchoring on an exceptional benchmark, in-group/out-group, communication breakdown, collective resistance, ignoring "subjective truth" from the front line.

4. Paul McGinley: Leading a Multinational Team of Individuals (Session 7.1)

Setting: Team Europe captain, **Ryder Cup 2014, Gleneagles, Scotland**, vs USA (captain **Tom Watson**). Named Jan 2013 by the players' committee. No prize money, only prestige. 12 players: 9 qualify (4 from the points list, 5 from world rankings) + 3 captain's picks. **Fri/Sat:** 4 fourballs (mornings, own ball, best score) + 4 foursomes (afternoons, alternate shots, one ball), so 4 players rest each session. **Sun:** 12 singles. Need 14 pts; holder retains on 14–14.

Background: Irish, Gaelic-football roots (broken kneecap at 19). Holed the winning putt in 2002, played 2004 and 2006, vice-captain 2010 and 2012 (won all 5). Captained GB&I at the Seve Trophy 2009 and 2011. Was never a star (ranked 6th–12th in his teams).

Challenges: individualistic sport ("selfishness is in a golfer's DNA"), many nationalities vs a one-nation US team, team confirmed only weeks before, three formats, being favourites at home, managing superstars.

What he did

- **Individuals within a team:** treated players as individuals; rolling buffet 6–10 pm with Mediterranean, British and Nordic food.
- **Identity:** players represent country, town and family as well as Europe; daily uniform colours with meaning (Fri = Scottish Saltire). Team-room quote: "The best teamwork comes from those individuals working individually towards one goal in unison."
- **Data:** strokeaverage.com analysed 10 yrs of Gleneagles data, and the course was "the exam" (the real opponent). Par 5s were key, and 3 of 4 par 5s plus the driveable par 4 were even-numbered, so foursomes pairs put a long hitter on the evens (e.g., Dubuisson + McDowell). Fourballs paired similar games.
- **Low-profile prep:** minimal contact so players stayed focused on their own season. Quietly **controlled tournament draws** so likely partners and caddies bonded without knowing why. Learned about players from press transcripts, managers and caddies.
- **Caddies empowered:** same treatment as players, private meetings, and they decided whether to pass on his messages.
- **5 vice-captains (a first):** 4 follow the matches, the 5th looks after the 4 resting players. "Three lines of attack": players and caddies → vice-captains → captain. He spoke to players through VCs and caddies.
- **Sir Alex Ferguson** as private sounding board; spoke Tuesday night (Canada geese in V formation). Artist Nick Bradley made the graphics. 30-min 9 pm meetings; private daily one-to-ones.

- **Don't overreact:** Westwood–Donaldson kept together after a morning loss because the VC said energy was fine, and they won in the afternoon. **Garcia media storm** (an ex-captain called him "useless"): 45-min talk, Olazábal to monitor him, McIlroy asked to play the senior role, and they won.
- Saturday night: refocus from team to individual for the singles; McDowell placed at the top of the order; graphic "We will be the rock when the storm comes."

Result: Europe **16½–11½**. Players: "most meticulous ever", "no stone left unturned". McGinley's metaphor: producer, director and scriptwriter of a West End play.

Themes: leading diverse teams, coordination vs cohesion, superordinate identity alongside subgroup identity, delegation and empowerment, enabling structures, information gathering, not over-captaining.

5. Henry Tam and the MGI Team (Session 10.1)

Setting: HBS Business Plan Contest, spring 2002 (post-dot-com crash, poor job market). Final plan due in **3 weeks**; mid-March with no first draft. Contest rule: at least one 2nd-year HBS MBA; prizes over $60K.

MGI (Music Games International): founded 2000 by 3 ex-Soviet immigrants. First pivot after the web-music business died. Product: **Tchaikovsky's Nutcracker: The Music Game** (CD-ROM, kids pick the 4 correct instruments out of 8). A critical success and a commercial failure (missed Christmas, no marketing). Patent pending on the "music substitution" puzzle.

Team (7)

- **Sasha Gimpelson:** co-founder, HBS MBA '87, Americanised, business and sales person, jumped across industries. Aggressive and blunt ("poor interpersonal skills"); called Dana's point "bullshit" in front of everyone.
- **Igor Tkachenko:** co-founder, composer, charismatic, workaholic, "the father" who holds the company together.
- **Roman Yakub:** co-founder, composer, creative visionary; conflicts with Sasha; pressured to "stick to the story" in stairwell huddles.
- **Henry Tam:** HBS '02 (JP Morgan, IFC, PwC). Calm, analytical, synthesiser, emerged as de facto leader of the plan.
- **Dana Soiman:** HBS '02, Romanian, ex-investment banking (CSFB, Barclays, Goldman). Structured and strict. **Clash with Sasha**.
- **Alex Sartakov:** Berklee student, Russian-trained musician; mediator who "bridges the gap".

- **Dav Clark:** MIT grad student, brought in by Sasha to enter the **MIT contest** without telling the others; quiet.

Key dynamics

- Mismatched expectations: Sasha saw the students as "interns" to call HBS alumni (brown envelope of names); Henry and Dana saw themselves as strategy leaders.
- Pre-formed bias about Sasha; a faultline of **"HBS vs the Russians"**; Henry and Dana pre-meet and play **good cop/bad cop** (Dana takes the extreme position, Henry the "compromise").
- 3rd meeting: their PowerPoint vs Sasha's pencil sketch on graph paper. "Coup", and Sasha felt ignored.
- Endless brainstorming (creative vs business mindsets); when each member stated their vision, all of them differed.
- **Core conflict: target market.** Henry and Dana want **education** (smaller but winnable; prove short term first). Founders want **entertainment / teen market** (bigger, matches music-industry contacts; education is low priority in schools and has entrenched competitors).
- Roles muddled; Henry and Dana overloaded as "CEOs of the group". No clear leader ("whoever had the most energy").

Themes: diversity and faultlines, task vs relationship conflict, stereotyping, coalitions and influence tactics, team launch and norms, role clarity, decision process, leadership emergence.

6. Managing a Global Team: Greg James at Sun Microsystems (A) (Session 11.1)

Setting: Sun Microsystems (2007: $14 bn revenue, about 35,000 employees, 47 countries). "Follow the sun" global teams; **Open Work** program (work anywhere; about 60% participation; real estate cut over 15%, about $0.5 bn saved). "Rule of 11" span of control. Case set May 2008.

Greg James: Stanford star engineer, Sun Outstanding Manager award; recruited by Pam Lawry (VP Global Markets) to lead a **45-person team**: **India 16, UAE 11, US 11, France 7**, built 12 months earlier (US team inherited from an acquisition).

The crisis (HS Holdings): online banking customer with a **$300K/yr 24x7 premium contract**. Server down **2 hrs** on Sunday 23:30 PST, the **second** time. Threat of a lawsuit; VP **Stephen Spurlock**: "Fix it. Fix it now."

What went wrong

- **Praveen Devilal** (Mumbai) paged the US on-call 3 times using the **weekday protocol** (it was still the weekend in California).
- He didn't call **Nick Elliott** (US account owner) because Nick was overheard saying the Indian team wasn't competent.
- The ticket sat in the **wrong queue**: **Jamal** (Dubai) built it for missing contract numbers from unclear instructions (the US asked Rahul's team, but Dubai built it); the second programmer checked it against the same wrong spec.
- Nick hadn't updated the customer contact number (the contact had moved departments).
- **Elisabeth Fournier** (Paris, customer advocate) got the customer call, couldn't reach Nick or Greg, and says the US is always slowest to respond.

Sub-team grievances

- **India (Rahul Ashok, Ashok tech lead):** treated as second-class on calls (last on the agenda, interrupted). Weekly call at **08:00 PST = 20:30 IST** after a 06:30 start. Stuck with maintenance and firefighting while others get the creative work.
- **France (Jacqueline Martin):** paid **30% less** than US peers (leaked salary); long, unpredictable hours. US resents French statutory vacations.
- **UAE (Ahmed Nazr):** feels neglected, lacks face time, fears coming under India, relationship-based business culture means missed deadlines. Tension with Rahul (Nazr is Pakistani).
- **US:** seen as Greg's **favourites** (water-cooler access; others cc'd after decisions). "The rich get richer."

Lawry's advice: build consensus, keep everyone engaged, keep it simple, manage disparate voices. **Greg's options:** visit sites more (weeks 1 and 3), reduce face time for all, multiple all-team calls, restructure the team, question Open Work fit.

Themes: virtual and global teams, faultlines and subgroups, in-group favouritism, fairness and equity, trust (swift trust), coordination across time zones, process and role clarity, cultural differences, leader as hub.

7. Asian Toys (role play) (Session 15)

Setting: Asian Toys, founded **1911** by Shiv Lal (wooden toys), moved to plastics in 1978. Chairman **Chamanlal** (founder's grandson). Product **Play Time** ("the toy that makes toys"): plastic parts, rubber rivets, hand tool. Rs 150–175 per set. Sales: 10,000 sets (year 1) → 20,000+ (last year) → **35,000 firm bookings** ready to ship for Dussehra, Diwali and Christmas.

Facts

- Death 1: **8-yr-old boy, Ahmedabad, 19 Jan**, rivet in the right lung. Company learned of it on 4 Apr from TMAI counsel. The Consumer Safety Commission (CSC) evaluated it and took no action; the company treated it as a freak accident.
- Death 2: **9-yr-old boy, Juhu (Mumbai)**, reported by a reporter on **Fri 13 Sep**, confirmed Monday; autopsy confirmed 4 days later. Both deaths about **7 months apart**, same part, same product.
- Safety standards: voluntary (TMAI, published by the Indian Standards Bureau). Play Time **meets all standards**, has no government pressure, and the company has had **no serious accident in 80 years**. Both deaths came from **misuse**. Manufacturers must report hazards under the Consumer Safety Act.

Options: (1) do nothing, (2) public statement + warning label, (3) modify product, (4) **total recall**. **Decision meeting:** GMs of Manufacturing, Marketing, Finance; PR Manager; Legal Adviser.

Themes: group decision-making, ethics vs profit, stakeholder perspectives and functional biases, groupthink and escalation, influence and negotiation in meetings, corporate responsibility and reputation.